

2026 UK Quiz Varsity

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PACKET 1

1: In one play by this author, a character wants to know whether he is being consulted as a cook or a coachman after he is asked to cook dinner for Mariane. In that play by this author, Élise opposes plans to marry her to an older man, whose name is borrowed from a Greek word for “hook.” Another play by this author of *The (*) Miser* ends with a *deus ex machina* situation involving an unmentioned King Louis XIV arresting one character. In that play by this author, Elmire is eavesdropped on when one character hides under a table to prove the identity of the title character. This author played the role of Orgon in the first performance of one of his plays, a character who is manipulated by the title religious hypocrite. For 10 points, identify this French playwright of *Tartuffe*.

ANSWER: Molière [or Jean-Baptiste Poquelin]

<OM, European Literature> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

1: An uprising in this town resulted in the execution of Dic Penderyn for a disputed crime. For 10 points each:
[10h] Name this town, the place of a namesake “Rising” which took place in 1831, and which saw the first use of a red flag to represent working-class activism. A significant number of the people involved in that uprising in this town were coal miners.

ANSWER: Merthyr Tydfil (“MER-thur TIDD-vill”) [or Merthyr Tudful, accept Merthyr]

[10e] In 2015, Ann Clwyd (“CLOO-id”), an MP from this party, called for Penderyn to be pardoned. Merthyr Tydfil and the South Wales valleys are historically a heartland for this traditionally centre-left UK-wide party.

ANSWER: Labour Party [accept Welsh Labour or Llafur Cymru]

[10m] Elected as MP for Merthyr Tydfil in 1900, this politician became the first leader of the Labour Party after its foundation six years later.

ANSWER: Keir Hardie

<ARW, British and Irish History> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

2: A 2x2x2 (“two by two by two”) arrangement of rotated U-shapes can be used to create a material with a unique value of this quantity. A negative value of this quantity has been observed in split ring resonators, an example of a left handed material. For a particle to emit Cherenkov radiation, the product of this quantity and particle velocity must exceed the speed of light. The arctangent of a ratio of two values of this quantity gives (*) Brewster’s angle. The product of one value of this quantity and sine of the incident angle is equal to the product of a separate value of this quantity and sine of the corresponding angle according to Snell’s law. For 10 points, name this quantity, which gives the ratio of the speed of light in the vacuum to the speed of light in a medium.

ANSWER: refractive index [or index of refraction; accept dielectric constant or permittivity or permeability before ‘speed of light’]

<EN, Physics> [ed. OM/EN] <1.5 dot>

2: This technique was described by L. Aschenbrenner as “a true tolerable monotony.” For 10 points each:

[10h] Identify this technique in keyboard instruments where the left hand plays a broken chord accompaniment where the notes of the chord are played lowest, highest, middle, highest.

ANSWER: alberti bass

[10m] A fast alberti bass appears throughout the *Presto* final movement of this C sharp minor piano piece. This piece is subtitled *quasi una fantasia*.

ANSWER: Ludwig van Beethoven's Piano Sonata No. 14 [accept Moonlight Sonata]

[10e] Alberti bass was used prominently throughout the Classical period in several piano sonatas by this composer. The finale of this composer's 11th piano sonata is often dubbed the "Rondo alla Turca".

ANSWER: Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart

<OM, Auditory Fine Arts> [ed. RL] <1.5 dot>

3: A reading of this book's chapters 38-41 by a contemporary movement known as "ecological theology" has been used to imply that God's interests aren't exclusively focused on humans. In this book, God asks four friends "Where were you when I laid the foundations of this earth?" Elihu ("el-EYE-hoo"), a critic of one character in this book, is described as an "angry young man". Chapter 41 of this book says "no one is fierce enough to rouse it. Who then is able to stand against me?" when describing a creature interpreted as a massive (*) sea serpent. The title character of this book is encouraged by his wife to curse God after he contracts boils all over his body. The title "man from the Land of Uz" of this book is the centre of a wager between God and Satan over his loyalty. For 10 points, identify this book of the Bible where God tests and punishes the always-faithful title man.

ANSWER: Book of Job

<OM, Religion> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

3: One character in this play describes an activity as a "world without collisions" in a school assignment. For 10 points each:

[10m] Identify this play that follows the title character's relationship with the servants Sam and Willie. Those character's friendship in this play is symbolised throughout by flying kites and ballroom dancing.

ANSWER: "Master Harold"...and the Boys

[10e] "Master Harold"...and the Boys was written by Athol Fugard, a writer from this country. This country is also home to the writer of *Disgrace*, J.M. Coetzee.

ANSWER: South Africa [or Republic of South Africa or RSA]

[10h] This work by Fugard is his only novel and follows the title character who leads a gang of Boston, Butcher and Aap. This novel was later adapted into a 2005 film written and directed by Gavin Hood.

ANSWER: Tsotsi

<OM, World Literature> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

4: Relativistic Kohn-Sham density functional theory predicts that one member of this group can behave as a semiconductor. A Russian-American collaboration announced the synthesis of that element in this group by fusing californium and calcium in 2006. A compound containing one member of this group as a cation was produced by Neil Bartlett by reacting that element with platinum hexafluoride. One member of this group is the most commonly used element to protect (*) weld areas from impurities. Several of these elements were discovered by William Ramsay using fractional distillation. These elements have the lowest atomic radius and highest ionisation energy of any elements in their period. Since these elements have a full valence shell of electrons, these elements are chemically inert. For ten points, which group of unreactive elements include argon, neon and helium?

ANSWER: noble gases [or group 8 or group 18, accept inert gases before mentioned, prompt on oganesson or xenon or argon]

<EN, Chemistry> [ed. SM/OM] <1.5 dot>

4: During a conference in this city, the diplomat Friedrich von Gentz received £600 and “the wildest promises” from a British politician. For 10 points each:

[10e] Name this city, the location of an 1815 Congress that established the new borders of post-Napoleonic Europe. That congress in this city was set in the capital of an empire governed by Francis I.

ANSWER: Vienna [or Wien, accept Congress of Vienna]

[10m] This conservative Austrian statesman oversaw the Congress of Vienna. This politician created the German Confederation to ensure Austrian dominance until his 1848 resignation.

ANSWER: Klemens von Metternich [or Prince Metternich, accept Klemens Wenzel Nepomuk Lothar, Prince of Metternich-Winneburg zu Beilstein]

[10h] Metternich’s downfall as Chancellor came during the 1848 Hungarian Revolution, which was led by this revolutionary. This revolutionary clashed with István Széchenyi (“EESH-tvan SAY-cheh-nyi”), who believed in a more cautious path to Hungarian autonomy.

ANSWER: Lajos Kossuth (“LAH-yosh KOH-shoot”)

<OM, European History> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

5: During this conflict, William le Gros began construction of Scarborough Castle, which was forfeited after this conflict ended. During this conflict, Robert of Gloucester was captured at the Rout of Winchester. One man involved in this conflict attempted to install his son Eustace as king but was rejected by the Catholic Church. One woman in this conflict escaped capture by fleeing across the (*) frozen Isis. During this conflict, one side lost Oxford and Stamford even after a peace agreement was signed at Wallingford. This conflict occurred after William Adelin died when the White Ship sank in the English Channel, leaving Henry I without a legitimate son. For 10 points, during which chaotic period of the 12th century did Stephen and Empress Matilda struggle for the English throne?

ANSWER: The Anarchy [or the Nineteen-Year War or the Nineteen-Year Winter]

<OH, British and Irish History> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

5: El Niño and La Niña are climate phenomena which predominately affect this ocean. For 10 points each:

[10e] Name this ocean which, in El Niño years, experiences a drastic increase in sea temperature off the western coast of South America.

ANSWER: Pacific Ocean [or South Pacific Ocean]

[10h] A main cause of the temperature increase in El Niño is the cessation of this process. Named after an English scientist, this closed process consists of cold water being brought up to the surface and is caused by heat differences between the ocean and land.

ANSWER: Walker circulation [or Walker cell]

[10m] The temperature shifts caused by El Niño can exacerbate this process, which is predominantly caused by global warming. In this process, polyps expel their zooxanthellae (“zoo-ZAN-thel-eye”), leading to a loss of pigment.

ANSWER: coral bleaching [prompt on any mention of coral dying or equivalents]

<EN, Other Science> [ed. OM/EN] <1.5 dot>

6: An essay written by this author describes a man and his son named ‘Nobody’ bringing about a ‘prehistoric silence’. One work by this author explores the life of a poet from his home country, examining her motivation to become a nun. This author’s collaborations with translator Eliot Weinberger include a poetry translation published in *Nineteen Ways of Looking at Wang Wei*. This author also wrote an essay with sections titled ‘The Conquest and Colonialism’ and ‘The (*) Sons of La Malinche’. A circular poem by this author opens and closes by describing a river that is “arriving forever”. That poem by this author, which takes its structure from the Aztec calendar, describes “a willow of crystal, poplar of water”. For 10 points, name this Mexican author of *The Labyrinth*

of Solitude and Sunstone.

ANSWER: Octavio **Paz** [or Octavio **Paz** Lozano]

<CT, World Literature> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

6: *Note to players: original language term required.*

According to doctrine, this practice is meant to help orphans, those to be freed from slavery and the stranded traveller amongst others. For 10 points each:

[10m] Identify this pillar of Islam which asks for almsgiving and is a religious duty for all Muslims who meet the criteria of wealth. This practice is usually set at 2.5% of a person's *nisab* or minimum income.

ANSWER: **zakat** [or **zakāt**, prompt on **almsgiving** or **tithes** or **charity**]

[10e] This denomination of Islam typically regards *zakat* as a private donation to imam-sponsored collectors, as opposed to Sunni Muslims who typically see it as a public action.

ANSWER: **Shia** Islam [or **Shia** Muslims]

[10h] This Islamic scholar argued that crops or food should not be counted in a Muslim's *nisab* when measuring *zakat*. This scholar and jurist names the largest school of Sunni jurisprudence.

ANSWER: Abu **Hanifa** [accept **Hanafi** School or **Hanafism**]

<OM, Religion> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

7: **Guitar players from this country often use D-A-D-G-A-D tuning, as it offers flexibility in playing accompaniment in this country's traditional music. Musicians from this country introduced the Greek bouzouki ("boo-ZOO-kee") to its traditional music in the 1960s. One composer from this country was the first to write nocturnes. Unaccompanied vocal music from this country is often performed in the (*) sean nós ("SHAHN-nos") or "old style". It's not Scotland, but drones played by uilleann ("ILL-un") pipes characterise the generally sparse harmony of this country's traditional music. For 10 points, identify this home country of the 12/8 ("twelve-eight") Munster slide dance.**

ANSWER: **Ireland** [or Republic of **Ireland** or **Eire**, anti-prompt on **Northern Ireland** or **Tuaisceart Éireann** or **Norlin Airlann**, reject "Great Britain" or "United Kingdom"] (The composer in the second line is John Field).

<OM, Auditory Fine Arts> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

7: This name is shared by characters who existed in four different time periods across four different series. For 10 points each:

[10e] Identify the name of these characters, who have worked for Richard IV, Elizabeth I, the future George IV and the British Army. The last of these characters goes over the trenches during the First World War.

ANSWER: Edmund **Blackadder** [accept The **Black Adder** or **Blackadder** II or **Blackadder** the Third or **Blackadder** Goes Forth]

[10m] In the third series of *Blackadder*, the only copy of this book is thrown into the fire by Baldrick, who has to rewrite it. Blackadder conducts research on aardvarks in order to begin rewriting the first page of this book.

ANSWER: **Dictionary** of the English Language [accept Dr Johnson's **Dictionary**]

[10h] Blackadder uses these objects to teach Baldrick maths. Baldrick notes that two of these objects plus two more equals "some" of these objects.

ANSWER: **beans**

<ARW, Pop Culture> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

8: **The quantity [read slowly] 4 divided by this number, all raised to the power of half the total number of complex embeddings, appears in Minkowski's bound. Rational multiples of powers of this number are outputs of the Riemann zeta function for even integers. This number is multiplied by 2 *i* in the denominator in Cauchy's Integral Formula. The square root of this number is the output of the (*) gamma function at one half. This number squared divided by six is the solution to the Basel Problem. This number times *i* is exponentiated**

in Euler's identity. In radians, the sine of an angle is zero if and only if it is a multiple of this number. For 10 points, name this constant roughly equal to 3.14.

ANSWER: pi [prompt on 3.14 until mention; reject "3"]

<RL, Other Science> [ed. RL] <1.5 dot>

8: Thenmozhi Soundarajan ("ten-MOH-zee sun-da-RAH-jan") has argued that this concept often neglects caste as a central axis for inequality. For 10 points each:

[10e] Identify this sociological concept that describes how different individuals' social identities and factors like gender and class can result in unique forms of overlapping discrimination and prejudice.

ANSWER: intersectionality [accept word forms, accept intersectional theory]

[10h] This feminist thinker coined the term intersectionality in her essay "Demarginalizing the Intersection of Race and Sex". This thinker's experiences on Anita Hill's legal team during her sexual harassment trial against Clarence Thomas influenced her analysis of race and feminism.

ANSWER: Kimberlé Crenshaw

[10m] Another thinker who used intersectional theory was this thinker, who introduced the 'oppositional gaze' concept in her 1981 book *Ain't I A Woman?* This thinker's pen name is usually styled in lower case so as to decenter herself from her writings.

ANSWER: bell hooks [or Gloria Jean Watkins]

<OM, Social Science> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

9: **One account states that this figure wore multiple different wigs to avoid assassination by his allies. This leader won a battle by luring his opponent across a river early on a winter morning, while his brother waited in an overgrown valley on their flank. While fighting against Pergamon, this leader is said to have shot clay pots filled with venomous snakes at enemy ships. After Flaminius' forces were ambushed on the north shore of a (*) lake, the Fabian strategy was implemented to defeat this leader. This general won victories at Lake Trasimene ("TRASS-im-EE-nee") and Cannae ("KA-nay") before being defeated at Zama by Scipio Africanus. As a child, this leader was forced to swear an oath that he would always be an enemy of Rome by his father Hamilcar. For ten points, name this Carthaginian general who led elephants over the Alps to reach the gates of Rome.**

ANSWER: Hannibal Barca [prompt on Barca]

<EN, Other History> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

9: The central figure in this photograph was identified as Florence Owens Thompson by a *Modesto Bee* journalist forty years after this photograph was taken. For 10 points each:

[10m] Name this 1936 Dorothea Lange photograph that depicts a woman staring anxiously into the distance and holding her two children.

ANSWER: Migrant Mother

[10e] *Migrant Mother* depicts Thompson during this historical period, during which she moved to California. This historical period was characterised by severe economic downturn, mass unemployment and the "Dust Bowl".

ANSWER: Great Depression [prompt on 1930s]

[10h] Another American photographer working during the Great Depression was this woman, who co-authored the book *Have You Seen Their Faces* about the period. This photographer is also known for her depiction of a certain activist and nationalist leader sitting at a spinning wheel.

ANSWER: Margaret Bourke-White [prompt on Bourke or White] (The nationalist leader was Mahatma Gandhi).

<OM, Other Fine Arts> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

10: **One participant in this event created a giant shoe made from scraps of discarded leather to avenge his father. In one account, this event is initiated by a blood-stained dog howling in front of a cave before being released from his captivity. In a different account of this event, a ship made from the fingernails of the dead**

was released to sail over a churning ocean. During this event, the sky splits in two to reveal a giant with a flaming sword being followed by the sons of (*) Muspell. One account says that three winters without summer will precede this event, which is followed by the sea serpent Jörmungandr (“YOR-mun-GAND-er”) rising from the ocean. This event culminates with the wolf Fenrir swallowing Odin alive. For 10 points, identify this event in Norse mythology surrounding an apocalyptic battle.

ANSWER: **Ragnarok** [or **Ragnarök**, prompt on the end of the world or the apocalypse or equivalents]

<OM, Mythology> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

10: At age 22, this politician was featured in *The Guardian*’s best-dressed people at the 2013 Glastonbury Festival. For 10 points each:

[10m] Name this politician, elected as MP for Gorton and Denton at a 2026 by-election. This politician is the first of her party to win a seat in the North-West of England and worked as a plumber before entering Parliament.

ANSWER: Hannah **Spencer**

[10e] Spencer was the first MP from this political party to win a seat in the North-West. This left-wing environmentalist party’s other MPs include Carla Denyer, who was succeeded as its leader by Zack Polanski.

ANSWER: **Green** Party of England and Wales [or the **Greens**]

[10h] Spencer succeeded this Labour politician as Gorton and Denton’s MP. This former minister was suspended in 2025 after sending offensive messages to a WhatsApp chat, later resigning in January 2026 citing health reasons.

ANSWER: Andrew **Gwynne**

<OM, Current Affairs> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

11: **In the episode “Secrets and Lies”, two characters with this profession fence whilst waiting for a disciplinary meeting to start. Another member of this profession teaches a pair of siblings the practice of ho’oponopono in a room that his mentor Adamson died in. That character earlier proclaims that this profession “is the job that keeps on giving” before amending “nightmares [and] (*) ulcers”.** Following a bus crash, a member of this profession hallucinates a woman with an amber necklace. Radiohead’s “No Surprises” plays over a scene in which a member of this profession goes through detox after realising he hallucinated a romantic encounter with Cuddy. A series surrounding members of this profession takes place over the course of a fifteen hour shift in Pittsburgh. For 10 points, Michael “Robbie” Robinavitch and Gregory House are members of what profession?

ANSWER: **doctors** [accept **surgeons**; accept **medicine**; accept **anatomists**; accept equivalents like **medical professionals**, reject “nurses”]

<RD, Pop Culture> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

11: One version of this literary work was originally attributed to “Lollius” although no writer with this name is known. For 10 points each:

[10h] Identify this epic poem written in Middle English, where the eloquent Pandarus leads the title characters astray. This work was primarily based on Boccaccio’s *Il Filostrato*, which depicts the title lovers more cynically.

ANSWER: **Troilus and Criseyde** (“cri-SAYD”) [graciously accept **Troilus and Cressida**, reject on either just “Troilus” or “Criseyde” or “Cressida”]

[10m] The author of *Troilus and Criseyde* also wrote about this character in a 14th century work, who represents a “loathly lady” motif. This character claims to have been married to three good husbands and two bad ones, including Jankyn.

ANSWER: The **Wife of Bath** [or **Alyson** or **Alys** or the **Wyf of Bathe**]

[10e] The Wife of Bath appears in *The Canterbury Tales*, a work by this author of *Troilus and Criseyde* and the so-called “Father of English Literature”.

ANSWER: Geoffrey **Chaucer**

<OM, British and Irish Literature> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

12: **Philippe Cassegrain created an origami-inspired style of these objects named *Le Pliage*. Takashi Murakami first found fame in the West for drawing “Monogramouflage” designs on these objects. They aren’t food or jewellery, but a Season 3 episode of *Sex and the City* popularised the “Baguette” type of these objects. The intrecciato technique of manufacturing these objects is the trademark of (*) Bottega Veneta.** Designs of these objects that placed labels on their exterior were a signature of Kate Spade. Following a chance meeting on a flight, Hermes (“er-MEZ”) began selling a notoriously expensive type of these objects named after Jane Birkin, who complained about their lack of pockets or handles. For 10 points, Louis Vuitton sell monogrammed designs of what fashion accessories, used to carry personal items?

ANSWER: hand**bags** [or **purses**, accept tote **bags**, accept **clutches**, accept **Longchamp** bag, accept **Birkin** bag until read]

<JB, Other Fine Arts> [ed. OM] <1.5-dot>

12: The third law of thermodynamics states that this quantity approaches a constant value as a system approaches absolute zero. For ten points each:

[10m] Name this quantity which is constant for a reversible adiabatic process. This quantity can be calculated by multiplying the Boltzmann constant by the natural logarithm of the number of microstates.

ANSWER: **entropy** [accept **S**]

[10h] An adiabatic process is a specific example of one of these processes, where pressure multiplied by volume to the power of an index n is kept constant.

ANSWER: **polytropic** processes

[10e] The polytropic index is equal to one for a process where this quantity is kept constant. The product of pressure and volume is equal to N times R multiplied by this quantity in the ideal gas equation.

ANSWER: **temperature** [accept **T**]

<EN, Physics> [ed. OM/EN] <1.5 dot>

13: **This character is shown a piece of plaster from a box marked “Most Precious Treasures” from when she had recommended it to a man who cut his finger. This character is annoyed at the presence of Augusta Elton, whom she believes thinks “much of her own importance”, during a trip to Box Hill. This character’s hypochondriac father frequently laments the marriage of a governess he calls (*) “poor Miss Taylor.”** This character was described by her creator as “a heroine whom no-one but myself will much like.” After being returned to Hartfield, Harriet Smith’s gratitude to Frank Churchill makes this character think they are in love. At the end of the novel in which she appears, this character marries Mr. Knightley. For 10 points, what title character fails in her attempts to match make in a novel by Jane Austen?

ANSWER: **Emma** Woodhouse [prompt on **Woodhouse**]

<FH, British and Irish Literature> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

13: A foil to this deity is created by Ea (“AY-ah”) from the dirt beneath his fingernail in the Song of Agūšaya. For 10 points each:

[10m] Name this Mesopotamian goddess of love and war, who was rejected by Gilgamesh when she requested he become her consort.

ANSWER: **Ishtar** [or **Ištar**, accept **Innana**]

[10e] After being rejected by Gilgamesh, Ishtar sends one of these animals to torment Uruk. In Greek myth, the Minotaur is a hybrid between one of these animals and a human.

ANSWER: a **bull** [accept **bull of Heaven**, accept **cow**]

[10h] While Ishtar was held in the underworld by this goddess, it is said that ‘no bull mounted a cow’ and ‘no man impregnated a woman’. This goddess was Ishtar’s sister, and ruled the Mesopotamian underworld.

ANSWER: Ereshkigal [accept Irkalla, accept Ninkigal]
<EN, Mythology> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

14: **Although similar examples have appeared before, the phrase “if all you have is a hammer, everything looks like a nail” is often called this thinker’s “hammer”. Along with Stanislav Grof and others, this thinker pioneered the transpersonal subfield of his discipline, which aimed to identify and study “mystical and ecstatic experiences”. Qualities such as aliveness and dichotomy-transcendence are positive in this thinker’s model of (*) metamotivated individuals, which includes Eleanor Roosevelt and Albert Einstein as examples. Contrasting with D-cognition, this psychologist identified B-cognition as a prerequisite to achieve “peak experiences”. This psychologist argued for a model that identifies resources necessary for survival as more urgent than those categorised as “esteem” and “self-actualisation”. For 10 points, name this psychologist who created an eponymous “hierarchy of needs”.**

ANSWER: Abraham Harold Maslow
<OM, Social Science> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

14: One section of this literary work opens with an epigraph from a Nikolay Nekrasov poem that opens “When from the darkness of delusion...” For 10 points each:

[10h] Identify this novella, narrated by a man living in a “dark cellar in St. Petersburg”. The narrator of this novella attempts to argue human action is driven by logic in terms of the problem “two plus two equals four”.

ANSWER: Notes from Underground [or Notes from the Underground or Letters from the Underworld or Notes from the Underworld or Zapiski iz podpól'ya]

[10e] *Notes from the Underground* was written by this Russian novelist, who also wrote about the murder of a pawnbroker in *Crime and Punishment*.

ANSWER: Fyodor Dostoevsky

[10m] Constance Garnett, one of the first English translators of Dostoevsky’s works, also rendered many of this other author’s works into English, such as the collection *A Sportsman’s Sketches* and the novel *Fathers and Sons*.

ANSWER: Ivan Turgenev
<OM, European Literature> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

15: **One figure in the left of this painting is depicted wearing a red cameo brooch, while potted plants can be seen over the figure’s shoulder. This painting inspired a Gordon Parks photograph which depicts the cleaner Ella Watson standing in front of a flag in Washington D.C. A red barn stands to the right of the Dibble House in this painting, which contains an uncharacteristic (*) arched window. This painting is one of the most famous of the Regionalist school. One figure in this painting was modeled on the artist’s sister, Nan Graham, who stood next to a dentist named Byron McKeeby in this work, which is set in Eldon, Iowa. For 10 points, identify this 1930 painting by Grant Wood depicting two austere figures, one of whom is holding a pitchfork.**

ANSWER: American Gothic
<OM, Visual Fine Arts> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

15: A fungus found in one species of these animals causes mucormycosis, which produces skin lesions and ulcers. For 10 points each:

[10h] Name this species of mammal, whose males possess a venom that can lead to oedema (eh-DEE-muh”) and heightened sensitivity to pain in the affected region. These mammals have ten sex chromosomes in five unique pairs, compared to two in most other mammals.

ANSWER: duck-billed platypus [accept Ornithorhynchus anatinus]

[10e] Platypuses are monotremes, the only extant order of mammals which perform this action. Animals that perform this action, instead of giving birth to live (“rhymes with alive”) young, are known as oviparous.

ANSWER: laying eggs [accept descriptive answers or equivalents]

[10m] All non-platypus monotremes are instead species of this type of animal. These other Australian monotremes are sometimes known as ‘spiny anteaters’ and come in short-beaked and St. David’s long-beaked species.

ANSWER: echidnas [or Tachyglossidae, accept specific species of echidna]

<EN, Biology> [ed. OM/SM] <1.5 dot>

16: After 1947, this city experienced rapid development due to the implementation of the Finger Plan. This city’s Central Library contains a 1999 modernist extension known as the “Black Diamond”. This city’s old Stock Exchange features a tower with four dragon’s tails coiled around it. This city’s only international airport is situated on a neighbouring island to the east named (*) Amager (“ah-MAH”). A large dome-roofed cathedral in this city is popularly known as the Marble Church and sits opposite Amalienborg (“am-AY-lee-en-bor”) Palace. This city contains the second-oldest amusement park in the world, Tivoli Gardens. This city is separated from another by the Øresund (“UR-sund”) straits, that other city is Malmö. The Little Mermaid statue is located in, for 10 points, what capital city of Denmark?

ANSWER: Copenhagen [or København]

<OM, Geography> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

16: Followers of this thinker coined the term “haecceity” (“heck-SEE-i-tee”), which denotes a property that makes a thing that particular thing. For 10 points each:

[10h] Name this priest and philosopher who created the doctrine of “univocity of being”, the belief that existence is the most abstract concept we can comprehend. This thinker’s principal doctrines are set out in his commentaries on the *Sentences* of Peter Lombard.

ANSWER: John Duns Scotus

[10m] Scotus was a follower of this philosophical movement, of which Anselm of Canterbury was called the “Father of”. Most popular in the 12-14th centuries, this movement sought to reconcile classical and ancient philosophy and Catholic theology through precise logic.

ANSWER: Scholasticism

[10e] Another influential scholasticist is this 13th century theologian who argued that God is the natural source of reason and faith and who synthesized Aristotelian philosophy with Catholic thought in his *Summa Theologica*.

ANSWER: Saint Thomas Aquinas [or Tommaso d’Aquino; prompt on Saint Thomas or Santo Tommaso]

<OM, Philosophy> <1.5 dot>

17: One king with this regnal name granted one company a monopoly over the creation of “popish soap”. The installation of one king with this regnal name was once celebrated on Oak Apple Day and was propagated by a military force commanded by George Monck. During one king of this regnal name’s reign, the Speaker John Finch was held down in his chair in Parliament, leading to a period of (*) “personal rule”. The most recent king of this regnal name endorsed an urban design experiment in a suburb of Dorchester. The first king of this regnal name was found guilty of high treason and was opposed by the New Model Army. For 10 points, identify this regnal name shared by three English and British kings, the second of which succeeded Oliver Cromwell’s Protectorate and the third of which is the current British monarch.

ANSWER: Charles [accept Charles I or Charles II or Charles III]

<OM, British and Irish History> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

17: One of this artist’s many portraits depicts an ambassador from Mysore gazing into the distance. For 10 points each:

[10h] Identify this 18th century artist who created over 660 portraits such as the aforementioned *Muhammad Dervish Khan*. This artist’s self portraits include one of this artist holding their daughter and one in a straw hat.

ANSWER: Élisabeth Vigée Le Brun [prompt on Vigée]

[10e] Le Brun served as the court painter to this royal figure, whom she depicted with a rose in one portrait. This wife of Louis XVI is often associated with the phrase “Let them eat cake”, even though there is no evidence for her saying it.

ANSWER: Marie Antoinette [accept Marie Antoinette with a rose, accept Maria Antonia Josefa Johanna]

[10m] Le Brun’s works often drew inspiration from neoclassicism and this other art movement, most popular in the mid-18th century. Also known as Late Baroque, this movement prioritised detailed ornamentation, drama and white and pastel colours.

ANSWER: Rococo

<OM, Visual Fine Arts> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

18: One criticism of this school of thought entails a "sheriff scenario" and was posited by H.J. McCloskey. An argument analogising a drowning child to Bangladeshi refugees was put forward by a thinker from this school of thought and appears in the essay “Famine, Affluence and Morality”. Henry Sidgwick was an early proponent of this school of thought and described this school’s “paradox of (*) hedonism” in one work. In his book *Principles*, R.M. Hare uses this school of thought’s “act” and “rule” theories to explain the outcomes of when people “take on the role of the ideal observer”. Jeremy Bentham was considered the modern father of this school of thought. For 10 points, identify this school of thought that advocates maximising happiness for the greatest number of people.

ANSWER: utilitarianism [accept ideal utilitarianism, accept act utilitarianism or rule utilitarianism, accept classical utilitarianism]

<OM, Philosophy> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

18: This polity was forced to review its foreign policy by the arrival of Matthew Perry’s “black ships”. For 10 points each:

[10m] Identify this polity that was overthrown by the Meiji Emperor in 1868. This polity’s namesake founder was a shogun often referred to as the third of the “Three Great Unifiers” of this polity’s modern nation.

ANSWER: Tokugawa Shogunate [or Tokugawa bakufu, accept Edo Shogunate or Edo bakufu]

[10e] The Tokugawa Shogunate was a dynasty from this modern-day country, then ruled by *daimyos* from the city of Edo.

ANSWER: Japan [or Nihon-koku or Nippon-koku]

[10h] The foundation of the Tokugawa Shogunate is usually regarded as this 1600 battle. During this battle, Tokugawa Ieyasu defeated a force loyal to the Toyotomi clan, from whom a number of major military leaders defected.

ANSWER: Battle of Sekigahara

<OM, World History> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

19: Elafibranor can be used to prevent a dangerous build up in this organ caused by PBC. Glucuronidation (“GLOO-cu-roh-ni-DAY-shun”) mainly occurs in this organ to increase the solubility of a pigment which may also serve as an antioxidant. This organ can be divided in two by Cantlie’s line in the Couinaud (“kwee-NOH”) classification. The rightmost of the two colic flexures is sometimes named for this organ. Three quarters of the blood flow into this organ comes from the (*) portal vein, which can experience hypertension when this organ experiences scarring. Eighty percent of the mass of this organ is made up of hepatocytes, which help it to perform its function of processing toxins like bilirubin. For 10 points, which large organ can be affected by cirrhosis as a result of alcohol abuse?

ANSWER: liver [prompt on bile ducts before ‘glucuronidation’]

<EN, Biology> [ed. OM/SM] <1.5 dot>

19: One character in this play defeats the Volscians (“VOLL-skee-unz”), then immediately allies with them. For 10 points each:

[10h] Name this tragedy by Shakespeare, centred on a general who tries to become consul. This play’s title character almost destroys Rome with the help of the Volscians, but is persuaded not to, resulting in his death.

ANSWER: Coriolanus [or *The Tragedy of Coriolanus*]

[10e] Coriolanus was written at the same time as this other Shakespeare play. This play follows the two title characters after the events of the play *Julius Caesar*.

ANSWER: Anthony and Cleopatra

[10m] This author proclaimed *Coriolanus* and *Antony and Cleopatra* to be superior to *Hamlet* in his essay collection *The Sacred Wood*. This author proclaimed that “aethereal rumours revive for a minute a broken Coriolanus” in an epic poem that ends with the Sanskrit line “shantih shantih shantih”.

ANSWER: T.S. Eliot [or Thomas Stearns Eliot] (that poem is *The Waste Land*)

<ARW, British and Irish Literature> [ed. OM/JB] <1.5 dot>

20: One of this author’s poems concerns two of this author’s brothers, with the speaker hoping that one will grow into manhood and the other shall return from a voyage. Another poem by this author discusses growing old and is titled for a Trojan prince admired by the goddess of dawn. It’s not Tennyson, but this author of the *Tithonus* poem was nicknamed “the (*) flower of the Graces” by admirers. Eva-Marie Voigt wrote a 1971 critical edition of this poet’s work, which formed the basis for Anne Carson’s *If Not, Winter*. Fragment 31 of this poet’s work was adapted by Catullus and describes this poet’s love for the young woman Anactoria. For 10 points, identify this “Tenth Muse” and Greek lyric poet from Lesbos.

ANSWER: Sappho [or Psápphō or Pssapha, accept Sappho of Lesbos]

<OM, Other Literature> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

20: These bonds consist of a sigma and pi bond and have a slightly shorter length than bonds with only a sigma component. For ten points each:

[10e] Name this type of bond, which is absent in alkanes but present in alkenes between two carbon atoms.

ANSWER: double bonds

[10h] Terminal alkenes can be polymerised with the help of these doubly-eponymous catalysts. These catalysts normally include titanium or vanadium.

ANSWER: Ziegler-Natta catalysts

[10m] Most Ziegler-Natta catalysts are of this type, where the phase of the catalyst is different from the phase of the reactants.

ANSWER: heterogenous catalysts

<EN, Chemistry> [ed. OM/SM] <1.5 dot>

21: This polity fought against armies commanded by Wladyslaw (“VWAD-i-swav”) III at the Battle of Varna. It’s not the Byzantine Empire, but after negotiations with Orban of Hungary, this empire bought a large piece of siege artillery, nicknamed the “Basilic”. This polity was documented in a set of letters written by Lady Mary Wortley Montagu, whilst her husband was an ambassador in this polity. Opposing this polity, the nationalist leader (*) Skanderbeg formed the League of Lezhë (“LEH-zhuh”) to fight against this polity in the 15th century. This empire moved its capital from Edirne (“ed-EER-neh”) to a city which it conquered with the help of the “Basilic” cannon in 1453. For 10 points, name this empire founded by Osman, which saw Sultans such as Murad and Mehmed rule from Constantinople.

ANSWER: Ottoman Empire [accept Sublime Ottoman State or Devlet-i ‘Alīye-i ‘Osmāniye]

<ARW, European History> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

21: One of these objects that sustained minimal damage in the 1996 Manchester bombing was fitted with a commemorative plaque. For 10 points each:

[10e] Name these objects, which usually include a royal cipher of the reigning monarch from when they were installed. After the 2012 Olympics, 110 of these objects were painted gold to represent Britain's gold medals.

ANSWER: pillar boxes [or post boxes; accept letter boxes; prompt on partial answers]

[10m] The first pillar box in the UK was installed at Botchergate in this county in its largest settlement and only city, Carlisle. A "travelling post office" operated in this county in the Victorian period to access towns such as Kendal.

ANSWER: Cumbria [prompt on Cumberland]

[10h] This author pioneered an early system of pillar boxes on the islands of Guernsey and Jersey. In this author's novel *He Knew He Was Right*, Miss Stanbury refers to a pillar box dismissively as "an iron stump".

ANSWER: Anthony Trollope

<OH, Other Academic> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>

22: **Due to the ability of a driver from this country to hold off faster competitors, the line of cars behind him was dubbed his namesake "train". This country's Grand Prix in 2008 saw Sebastian Vettel claim his first win in Formula One. In the 2024 F2 season, a driver from this country was teammates with Ollie Bearman. After Max Verstappen and Lewis Hamilton crashed into each other, Daniel Ricciardo and (*) Lando Norris achieved a 1-2 for McLaren in a Grand Prix in this country in 2021. Although their parent team is based in Austria, Red Bull's junior team Racing Bulls is based in this country. A race track in this country is dubbed "The Temple of Speed". At the 2026 Chinese Grand Prix, a driver from this country became the youngest polesitter in a Grand Prix, and currently partners George Russell at Mercedes. For 10 points, name this home country of Kimi Antonelli, whose Grand Prix in Monza is the home race of Ferrari.**

ANSWER: Italy [or Italia] (The driver in the first line is Jarno Trulli.)

<RL, Pop Culture> [ed. JB] <1.5 dot>

22: This law stated that the requirement to own land was to merely live in a house with a hearth sufficient to boil a pot. For 10 points each:

[10m] Identify this 1832 law that massively changed the English and Welsh electoral system, expanded the franchise and eliminated so-called "pocket" and "rotten boroughs".

ANSWER: Representation of the People Act 1832 [Accept Great Reform Act 1832 or 1832 Reform Act or First Reform Act]

[10h] One "rotten borough" that was abolished was this constituency, centered on a hill in Wiltshire. Due to its extremely low population, this constituency was essentially controlled by the Pitt family.

ANSWER: Old Sarum

[10e] Support for the Great Reform Act was preceded by an 1829 act that improved political mobility for this religious group. Support for this religious group was typically opposed to by the Tories, who instead supported Protestantism.

ANSWER: Roman Catholics

<OM, British and Irish History> [ed. OM] <1.5 dot>